

Trichr-o-matic — Changelog (English)

This file tracks what changed for users between builds, starting from v0.4.0. It's the release-notes counterpart to `CLAUDE.md` (which covers *how* things are implemented, for development) — this one covers *what changed and why it matters to someone using the app*.

A French version lives in `CHANGELOG_FR.md`. A PDF copy of each (`CHANGELOG_EN.pdf` / `CHANGELOG_FR.pdf`) is regenerated automatically by `build_mac.sh` on every build (`scripts/generate_changelog_pdf.py`), so they're always in sync with whatever `.app` you're holding.

The **Unreleased** section at the top always lists what's changed since the last version was actually built, plus a running list of what's planned next — so it doubles as a short roadmap snapshot, not just a history.

Unreleased

Remaining tasks for future versions

- **v0.6.0**: a **metadata panel** - not yet specified.
- **RAW file support** - not started; scoped in conversation, not yet prototyped.
- A handful of older error dialogs (image load errors, auto-align failure, session-load errors) still use the old system-dialog look and haven't been switched over to the app's own alert style yet.

v0.5.0 — 2026-09-08

Added

- **A clear Mode selector** for every photo (Files block): **Solo** (a single already-composed photo, edited as-is), **B&W Trichrome** (the classic case - 3 black & white shots recomposed into color), or **Color Trichrome** (3 real color photos, each keeping its own R/G/B channel, for a genuine "Harris Shutter" look) - each with its own icon. The Batch Import window gained the same 3-way choice for importing many photos at once, alongside

clearer wording throughout (renamed sections, and "?" info buttons explaining exactly how automatic file matching works).

- **Drag and drop photos from Finder** straight onto the thumbnail strip - each one is added to the session as a new Solo photo.
- **Curves:** a new tool block for direct tone-curve editing, with independent Y (master), R, G, and B curves - click the diagonal line to add a point, drag it to reshape the curve (including the two endpoints, which can now move both directions for a real black/white point), double-click a point to remove it. The curve line and a translucent histogram behind it both match whichever channel you're editing; that background histogram always shows the image *before* your curve edits, so you can see exactly what you're starting from - the main Histogram panel still shows the final, corrected result.
- **Scan tool integrated into the app** as a regular block, alongside Trichrome Process/Light/Color/Crop/Curves - tethered capture from a connected camera, live connect/disconnect status, 3 film types (Black & White / Color / Color Reversal), an optional on-screen RGB backlight (including an automatic red/green/blue 3-shot sequence for scanning straight into a trichrome triplet), and **film-base color correction** for color negatives (sample the film's clear base, or pick it directly from an already-imported photo, to remove the orange-mask color cast). Finished captures are now added to the current session automatically - no more manual "Add to Session" step.
- **A real Black & White toggle** in the Color panel - a genuine luminance-weighted grayscale conversion, available in every mode, rather than just zeroing out saturation (which could make different colors of the same brightness read as the same shade of gray).
- Every "?" info button in the app now also opens after hovering for half a second, not just on click.

Changed

- Both histogram charts (the Histogram panel and the Curves tool's own overlay) now plot bin height on a plain linear scale - tall and short peaks read at their real relative sizes. A single very

dominant spike (e.g. a large pure-black or pure-white area) can still dwarf the rest of the chart - the small clip-warning bars at the chart's edges are there for exactly that case.

- "RGB Channels" renamed **Trichrome Process**, and it (along with Auto Align and Lock Layer Position, now living inside it) visibly grays out with a clear message whenever it doesn't apply to the active photo (Solo mode) - matching how every other tool block behaves when it's not usable, instead of just disabling a few controls quietly.
- The Batch Import window's "Advanced Options" section renamed **Import Rules**, "Input folder" renamed **File Selection**, and "Semi-automatic" renamed **Sequential**; its unmatched-files list is now a compact count with the full list available on hover instead of a long, always-visible line of filenames.

Removed

- The temporary webcam/iPhone testing option for the Scan tool, only ever meant to stand in for a real tethered camera during development.

v0.4.5 — 2026-09-04

Added

- **Fully customizable layout**: every panel - Files, RGB Channels, Histogram, Light, Color, Crop, and Scan - is now its own independent block. Drag a block by its grip to reorder it, move it to the other side panel, collapse it down to just its header, or close it entirely; a new **Tools** menu lists every block with a checkbox to bring closed ones back.
- **Layout Presets** (Window ▸ Layout Preset): save your own named panel arrangements, then load, update, or delete them anytime.
- **Quick layout switches**: the top toolbar's Trichrome / Color Correction / Crop / Scan buttons (and their T/E/C/S shortcuts) now jump straight to your own saved layout for that task - only one is active at a time. The same 4 shortcuts are also listed directly in the Window menu, with Update available right there too.

- **Reset Layout** (Window menu) restores the default panel arrangement in one click.
- Global Correction is now two separate panels, **Light** (exposure, brightness, contrast, highlights/shadows, black/white points, gamma, and Negative) and **Color** (temperature, tint, saturation, white balance eyedropper) - place each independently on either side of the screen.

Changed

- The Crop tool's active drag mode is now a dedicated button in its own panel, separate from whether the panel is simply visible - it no longer turns on or off unexpectedly as you rearrange your layout. Escape now only exits crop mode without changing your layout; switching to a different saved layout automatically turns crop mode off, and switching to the Crop layout turns it back on.
- "Independent Channels" renamed to **RGB Channels**.
- Smaller, more consistent block headers throughout, with matching icon sizes.
- Language selection moved to the **Help** menu (Help ▶ Language).
- A newly installed or updated version no longer reopens whatever session was last open - the first launch always starts empty, so you'll need to open an existing session or start a new one.

Removed

- The Crop panel's own Copy button (redundant with ⌘C / the filmstrip's Copy and Paste Crop).

v0.4.4 — 2026-09-02

Added

- **Window menu:** Close Window, and toggles for the Left Panel, Right Panel, and Thumbnails strip - each with its own keyboard shortcut (⌘W, I, O, P).
- **Exposure slider**, in both Independent Channels and Global Correction, sitting just above Brightness. Unlike Brightness (a

simple lightening/ darkening nudge), Exposure is a proper photographic stops (EV) control that behaves like a real exposure change - pushing it hard blows out highlights the way overexposing a shot would.

- **Histogram pixel picker:** a new eyedropper button next to the histogram's Reset. While it's active, hovering the preview draws a live marker showing exactly where that pixel falls on the Y/R/G/B curves.

Changed

- Histogram redesign: subtle shadow/midtone/highlight guide lines in the background, and a softer, Lightroom-style look for the overlapping channel curves (a translucent fill with a crisp outline on top).
- The histogram's clipping indicators are more accurate: a thin, often invisible black/white border introduced by slightly misaligned channels (or the Straighten tool) is no longer mistaken for real over/ underexposure, and the indicator now scales with how much is actually clipped instead of always jumping to the same size.
- Soloing a channel's B&W preview now automatically highlights that channel's scope in the histogram (the histogram's own Reset button turns Solo preview back off again), and now also reflects any Global Correction "Light" adjustments (Exposure, Brightness, Contrast, Highlights, Shadows, Whites, Blacks, Gamma) - it used to ignore Global Correction entirely while a channel was soloed. Color-only adjustments (Temperature, Tint, Saturation) are still skipped, since they don't mean anything on a black & white preview.

Fixed

- **Harris Shutter Effect** now correctly remembers each photo's own setting - previously, switching between photos could leave the checkbox showing the wrong state, and in rare cases a batch export could reinterpret a photo's channels under the wrong mode. Both Harris Shutter and Negative can now also be applied to several selected photos at once - toggling one always sets every selected photo to the same new state, rather than flipping each photo's own existing setting individually.

- The missing-files relink window's "Relink..." button no longer gets stuck disabled after resolving one photo when others in the list still need fixing.

v0.4.3 — 2026-09-02

Added

- **White balance eyedropper.** A "Pick White Balance" tool in the Color section: click it, then click any point in the preview that should be neutral gray, and Temperature/Tint are set automatically to neutralize it. A "Reset" button next to it clears Temperature, Tint, *and* Saturation back to default.
- **Reset Light button.** Resets all 7 "Light" sliders (Brightness, Contrast, Highlights, Shadows, Whites, Blacks, Gamma) at once, next to the "Light" section title.
- **Recovery for missing/moved source photos.** If a session is reopened and some original R/G/B files were moved or deleted, the affected photo(s) no longer silently disappear from the filmstrip. The preview instead shows exactly which file(s) are missing and their last-known location, with a **Locate** button that relinks them (across every selected photo at once) by searching a folder you pick.
 - If some files still can't be found this way (e.g. renamed rather than moved), a dialog lists them in a table - hover a row to see its original file path, or select a row and click **Relink...** to pick that exact replacement file directly, without needing to go find it via the left panel.
- **Reset buttons now grey out** whenever there's nothing to reset - across the whole app: Global Correction, Light, Color, each channel's own alignment/color reset, and the Crop panel.
- **This changelog**, in English and French, with an auto-generated PDF copy of each kept in sync with every build.

Changed

- Negative/invert moved into the Global Correction panel's header, next to Reset, as an icon (dims when off, lights up when on) instead of a text checkbox further down the panel - it's significant enough in trichromy (wrong polarity ruins the whole

image) to sit up top.

- The small warning-glyph info icon that used to sit next to Reset (hinting that per-channel corrections wouldn't be cleared by it) was removed from the Global Correction header; the "?" info button explaining the panel's own scope stays.
- Alert/warning dialogs now match the app's own look instead of macOS's generic system dialogs.

v0.4.2 — 2026-09-01

Added

- **Harris Shutter Effect.** An opt-in mode (checkbox below the channel panels) for people who load 3 *color* photos instead of black & white ones - it extracts the real R/G/B channel from each source instead of converting to grayscale, for a genuine Harris Shutter look. Off by default; regular black & white trichromy is unaffected either way.
- **Redesigned sliders** across the whole app: every slider now visually centers on its own default, filling left or right from that point so it's obvious at a glance whether a value is above or below normal. Numbers are now a clean, click-to-type value instead of a spinbox, and color-correction sliders display as -100...+100 (Lightroom-style) while sliders with a real physical unit (pixels, degrees, zoom) keep their own unit.
- Export window: "Show in Finder after export" option.
- **⌘W** now closes the active secondary window (Export, Import, Help) without quitting the app.
- New crop aspect ratio preset: 7:5.
- Crop grid overlay: 4 styles to choose from (3×3, 2×2, Golden Ratio, fixed-size squares), replacing the old 2-option picker.

Changed

- "Global Color Correction" renamed to **Global Correction**, and split into two clearly labeled sections: **Light** and **Color** (Temperature, Tint, Saturation, in that order).
- Crop aspect ratio presets reordered (most-square to widest)

and the orientation icon now visually rotates to match your selection.

- The Crop and Global Correction panels now match each other exactly in layout, so switching between them doesn't shift anything on screen.

Fixed

- Cropping with a locked aspect ratio near the edge of a photo no longer distorts the ratio.

v0.4.0 / v0.4.1 — 2026-08-31

(v0.4.1 was a same-day follow-up bugfix/polish pass on v0.4.0; changes below cover both.)

Added

- **New Session**, a proper multi-photo session system, and the photo filmstrip's right-click menu (Reset All, Duplicate).
- Help menu content rewritten to match everything above.

Changed

- Shortcuts reference reorganized into General / Navigation / Preview / Sliders sections; the "active channel" explanation moved into a live "?" info button next to each channel's Active checkbox.
- Sidebar layout polish: cleaner section titles, histogram split into its own block, larger/repositioned reset buttons.
- The tool switcher (Global Correction $\rightleftharpoons$ Crop) moved into the top toolbar as two buttons, with **E** / **C** shortcuts.

Removed

- A handful of unused, dead translation strings cleaned out during an English/French text audit.